

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A1: Register across Time

Distinguish graphic, lexical, syntactic, stylistic, register, and historical claims and scale each claim to cited evidence

Stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisite	Passage of EL-GATE-III, including its M-C unfamiliar-formulary transfer, and direct-reading competence
Next	EL-A2, Vulgate Texture and Biblical Idiom

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A1. Register across time

Advanced reading must not assume that every Latin text belongs to one uniform linguistic setting. This course compares forms in the *Missale Romanum* (1962) with identified biblical, liturgical, and rubrical texts. Good analysis first describes what a form does in its passage. A claim about its history or source belongs only after a dated witness or a cited parallel supplies evidence for that claim.

A **register** is a variety of language associated with a recurring purpose, community, or textual setting. Register differs from **period**, which locates language in historical time, and from **genre**, which groups whole texts by communicative and liturgical job. Thus a fourth-century prayer and a twentieth-century rubric can differ in period, genre, and register; none of those labels by itself evaluates the Latin's quality.

In this course, an **orthographic** feature concerns spelling or written form; a **lexical** feature concerns word choice or contextual sense; a **syntactic** feature concerns dependencies among words and clauses; and a **stylistic** feature concerns patterned choices among grammatical possibilities, such as balance, repetition, or order. One feature may belong to more than one level, but the commentary must say what precisely is being observed.

On completing this unit, you can:

- distinguish orthographic, lexical, syntactic, and stylistic differences;
- use a classical grammar as a baseline without treating later Latin as failed classical prose;
- identify Christian specialization of an inherited word; and
- write an evidence-based register note rather than a vague label.

1.1 Four questions for a marked feature

A **marked feature** is one that stands out against the comparison norm chosen for the inquiry. It is not automatically rare, late, erroneous, or important. The **baseline** is that stated comparison norm; a classical grammar supplies a useful baseline for continuity and difference, not a rule that every later register was trying and failing to imitate.

When a form looks unusual, ask in order:

1. Is the difference only typographic? *æ/ae, j/i*, and punctuation may vary without grammatical change.
2. Is it already accounted for by the stated comparison grammar, such as extensive coordination or a postpositive particle?
3. Does the immediate Christian context require a specialized sense? *gratia, sacramentum, confessio*, and *passio* cannot safely be read from one context-free gloss.
4. Does a cited biblical source or securely dated parallel exhibit the same construction? If so, record the comparison; do not assign a cause or period from an unusual-looking form alone.

Coordination joins units of equal syntactic rank; **parataxis** is the placing of clauses or phrases side by side with little or no explicit subordination. A **postpositive** word cannot normally stand first in its clause or phrase and instead follows its first word or constituent, even when it logically connects the whole unit. In this course, **Christian specialization** names a contextually restricted Christian sense of an existing

lexeme. Reconstructing when or how that sense developed is a separate historical claim and requires dated lexical evidence.

Worked example: *Et Verbum caro factum est*

Worked passage ID: W.IV.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Et Verbum caro factum est, et habitavit in nobis (John 1:14, Clementine Vulgate) uses familiar inflection and clause coordination. *Verbum* is a nominative subject; *caro* is a predicate nominative; *factum est* is third-person singular perfect indicative in the perfect system of *fio*, which also supplies the passive of *facio*; its neuter participle agrees with *Verbum* and here may be rendered “became” or “was made.” *Habitavit* shares the subject. The Christian contextual sense of *Verbum* and the paratactic coordination are observable here; any wider register or historical claim should rest on comparison with cited texts. Merely writing “late Latin” explains nothing.

1.2 Contextual sense without etymological fallacy

The **etymological fallacy** is the mistake of treating a word’s origin or an earlier sense as its necessary meaning in another passage. This exercise establishes sense from construction and immediate context; it does not by itself reconstruct semantic history. A claim about change across periods requires dated, cited witnesses. Etymology may suggest a question, but it does not answer that question.

Context and construction determine the local sense. In the sacrificial prose studied here, *hostia* denotes a victim or oblation; it is not *hostis*, “enemy.” In a sanctoral heading, *confessor* names an ecclesiastical category rather than anyone who happens to admit something. These are contextual analyses, not a reconstruction of either word’s history. Record a lexical note as:

lemma; construction; sense in this passage; one close parallel; contrast with a plausible but wrong sense.

1.3 Composition laboratory

Take a classical-looking sentence, a Vulgate verse, and a collect. Underline what all three share in ordinary morphology. Box only features that genuinely distinguish register. Then write a 100-word English note that supports every historical claim with a form or parallel.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Four questions for a marked feature — transfer practice

Connection. A reproducible register note separates the page's feature, the comparison norm, the checked parallel, and the remaining inference.

Transfer task. For the lesson's worked passage, make four columns: observed form, ordinary grammar, stated baseline, and claim still requiring a dated witness.

Retrieval check. Classify each row as observation, comparison, inference, or unresolved.

1.2 Contextual sense without etymological fallacy — transfer practice

Connection. Construction and immediate context choose among lexical senses before word history is considered.

Transfer task. Take one specialized lemma already discussed in the lesson and record construction, local participants, defensible sense, tempting wrong sense, and the evidence excluding it.

Retrieval check. Explain why origin cannot compel the same sense in every period or genre.

1.3 Composition laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. Register-controlled composition requires declared models and an audit trail, not a cloud of period-sounding vocabulary.

Transfer task. Write three project-composed Latin sentences expressing one proposition in plain narrative, prayer-shaped, and rubric-style registers; label every deliberate structural difference.

Retrieval check. Identify one morphological feature shared by all three.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

A1 worksheet family: register across time

Worksheet IV.1 — Orthography without panic

Worksheet ID: IV.1

Focus: Distinguish typography from grammar.

Use: Use before making historical claims about a spelling.

1. Rewrite *cæli et terra* with expanded ligature; identify every morphological fact that changes.

-
2. Normalize *ejus misericordia* to the common classical spelling and parse both words.

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3. Normalize *juventutem meam*; explain why normalization is not translation.

-
4. For *præsta*, *quæsumus*, expand ligatures and parse both verbs.

-
5. Write a two-sentence rule for when an orthographic variant belongs in a grammatical commentary.
-

Worksheet IV.3 — Register diagnosis**Worksheet ID:** IV.3**Focus:** Support a register judgment with forms.**Use:** Choose after A1-A or A1-B.

1. **Text:** *Et Verbum caro factum est, et habitavit in nobis.*

Passage ID: IV.3.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the forms, then distinguish direct observations from register inference.

-
2. Why is repeated *et* insufficient by itself to prove that a sentence is ungrammatical or nonclassical?

-
3. Classify each difference: *æ/ae*; *salvare* in Christian sense; a changed case ending; a semicolon added by an editor.

-
4. Revise the claim “This is bad Latin because it says *et* three times.”

-
5. Write a register note on a five-line Missal passage. Separate observation, comparison, and inference.
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Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Given three unattributed passages, classify observable features, state a comparison baseline, propose register only from cited evidence, and leave period, cause, or development unresolved where dated witnesses are absent.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-A2, Vulgate Texture and Biblical Idiom.

If it is not met: Worksheets IV.2 and IV.4 remain optional semantic-specialization and register-composition practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Four questions for a marked feature — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model treats morphology and coordination as observations, any classical comparison as baseline-dependent, and historical cause or period as unresolved unless a dated cited parallel is supplied.

Contextual sense without etymological fallacy — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing note derives the local sense from governor, objects, modifiers, and context. Etymology may motivate a question but cannot override those controls.

Composition laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Models vary, but each sentence must be grammatical, preserve the proposition, declare its instructional status, and defend register from syntax and lexicon. Ordinary case and agreement should remain shared rather than falsely treated as register markers.

CHAPTER 2

A1 worksheet family: register across time

Solution IV.1 — Orthography without panic

Worksheet ID: IV.1

Focus: Distinguish typography from grammar.

Use: Use before making historical claims about a spelling.

1. Rewrite *cæli et terra* with expanded ligature; identify every morphological fact that changes.
Answer / model: *caeli et terra*. No morphology changes: *caeli* remains nominative plural masculine of *caelum*; *terra* remains nominative singular feminine.
2. Normalize *ejus misericordia* to the common classical spelling and parse both words.
Answer / model: *eius misericordia*: *eius* genitive singular of *is, ea, id*, modifying *misericordia*; *misericordia* is nominative or ablative singular here until syntax decides.
3. Normalize *juventutem meam*; explain why normalization is not translation.
Answer / model: *iuventutem meam*. Only *j/i* typography changes; both remain accusative singular feminine, noun plus agreeing possessive.
4. For *præsta, quæsumus*, expand ligatures and parse both verbs.
Answer / model: *praesta, quaesumus*: *praesta* present active imperative 2 singular of *praesto*; *quaesumus* present active indicative 1 plural of *quaeso/quaeso*, used parenthetically.
5. Write a two-sentence rule for when an orthographic variant belongs in a grammatical commentary.
Answer / model: Model: Record it when it affects identification, dictionary lookup, textual comparison, or historical register. Do not treat a ligature or *j/i* difference as a new case, tense, or lexical meaning.

Solution IV.3 — Register diagnosis

Worksheet ID: IV.3

Focus: Support a register judgment with forms.

Use: Choose after A1-A or A1-B.

1. **Text:** *Et Verbum caro factum est, et habitavit in nobis.*

Passage ID: IV.3.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the forms, then distinguish direct observations from register inference.

Answer / notes: *Verbum* is the subject and *caro* a predicate nominative. *Factum est* is third-person singular perfect indicative in the perfect system of *fio*, which also supplies the passive of *facio*; *factum* is neuter singular with *Verbum*, here “became/was made.” *Habitavit* is perfect active with the same subject. The Christian contextual sense of *Verbum* and the paratactic coordination are observations; their wider register significance requires comparison with the identified Johannine source and other cited texts.

2. Why is repeated *et* insufficient by itself to prove that a sentence is ungrammatical or nonclassical?

Answer / model: Coordination with *et* is grammatical. Its frequency may support a corpus comparison when documented, but this feature by itself proves neither date nor source-language influence.

3. Classify each difference: *æ/ae*; *salvare* in Christian sense; a changed case ending; a semicolon added by an editor.

Answer / model: Orthographic; lexical/semantic register; morphological/substantive; punctuation/editorial.

4. Revise the claim “This is bad Latin because it says *et* three times.”

Answer / model: Model: “The three coordinated finite clauses are grammatical. A register note should compare their sustained parataxis with an identified biblical source or corpus before drawing a historical inference.”

5. Write a register note on a five-line Missal passage. Separate observation, comparison, and inference.

Answer / model: A sound answer quotes exact forms, identifies ordinary morphology, documents specialized vocabulary or repeated structure, names a close parallel, and signals uncertainty. A mere period label earns no credit.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A1, *Register across Time*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The packet teaches disciplined comparison, not a general history of Latin or authority to date an unattributed text from one feature.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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